

Resistive

Resistive touchscreens are cheap and affordable, but painful to use. They aren't very responsive because of the inherent technology. User needs to apply a certain amount of pressure in order to complete the circuit and register the touch. This can be done with a stylus and fingernails too. In addition, they also lack the multi-touch functionality rendering many functions unusable. If you plan to buy a tablet strictly for educational purposes with minimum gameplay, tablets with resistive touchscreens will be light on your pocket and you won't miss out much.

Capacitive

Capacitive touchscreens on the other hand, provide a very smooth and pleasant interface for users to operate their tablets. These screens are sensitive and able to register the slightest touch by fingers or any other conducting device. There are styluses specially for capacitive screens which introduces handwriting recognition and enables you to draw on your tablets - Galaxy Note for instance. Capacitive screens aren't as expensive as they used to be. They offer multi-touch and all the other bells and whistles you'd need.

CPUs

Processors, on tablets perform the same functions that processors on PCs perform. This includes execution of apps and games or other functions like accessing web, performing calculations etc. These processors however are usually not the x86 variety and are designed by ARM. The important thing to consider here is the 'clock speed' which determines how quick the tablet is at performing tasks. Generally it is measured in MHz and GHz, it is very important not to overlook this specification while buying tablets.

So far, ARM architectures are the most dominant in the tablet industries when it comes to processors. Cortex-Ax series is the most commonly used amongst tablets. The series has four different designs - A5, A8, A9, A15. Speed and price goes on increasing as we move up the series, and so does the power consumption. Today A8 and A9 are the most popular processors in the market which operate between 600 Mhz to 1.2GHz. Since we are talking about tablets, it is best to have at least 1GHz of processor speed for optimum performance.

These processors come on what is called an SoC or System on Chip. SoCs combine a few modules on to a single chip such as a memory controller, graphics module etc. Companies like Texas Instruments, Qualcomm, and others manufacture processors and SoCs with their own code names such